

Colorado Field Ornithologists Sight Record Form

CFO-RC FILE X:

RESULTS:

Species:(Common Name) Least Bittern

(Scientific Name) *Ixobrychus exilis*

Date(s) of occurrence: 15 May 2000

Number of birds seen: 1 heard

Sex: male if only males "sing"

Plumage: ?

Location marsh south of HH road, west of Ft. Lyon, Bent County, Colorado

Length of observation: heard calling for about five minutes

Time(s) of observation: 30 minutes after sunset

Other observers who saw the bird(s) with you: none

Other Observers who independently saw the bird(s): Todd Dilley, Brandon Percival, Mark Janos

Conditions: warm, calm, more mosquitoes than necessary!

Optical equipment used: B & L Elite 10 x 42 binocular.

Distance from bird(s) (estimated unless otherwise noted): 100 meters.

Photos: no

Habitat: cattail marsh

Details: I heard that at least a couple Least Bitterns were being seen at this locale. I got there just after sunset and enjoyed many calling Black Rails. About half an hour later, I heard this bird "sing" its distinctive, Black-billed Cuckoo-like "coocococoo." The "song" sounded different from a Black-billed Cuckoo in being rather flat and less "wooden." It repeated this vocalization about 6 times, each spaced 30 - 60 seconds apart. I did not hear it again that night, or on numerous returns in May and June.

What is your prior experience with this and similarly appearing species? I have seen and heard this species in WI, MN, IN, TX, and NJ. I hear it more often than see it.

List books, guides, recordings or other sources consulted and how this influenced your identification (during and after observation): None.

This report is from notes made after observation.

Date of written report: 5 February 2001

Reporting observer: Christopher L. Wood, zeledonia@att.net

Signature: *Christopher L. Wood (electronic submission)*

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